

March

29

Carbon curve

The first measurements of carbon dioxide levels in Earth's atmosphere were taken in the Mauna Loa Observatory in Hawaii, USA. The daily data is plotted on a graph called the Keeling Curve, which monitors the link between burning fossil fuels such as coal, oil, or petrol, and levels of carbon dioxide. This gas is the biggest cause of climate change.

1958

Also on this day

1807 German astronomer **Wilhelm Olbers** spotted Vesta – the brightest asteroid in the sky.

1849 Maharaja of the Punjab, **Duleep Singh**, signed the Treaty of Lahore, giving the British East India Company land in India.

2017 British prime minister **Theresa May** triggered Article 50 of the Treaty on European Union to begin Brexit, the UK's departure from the EU.



1974

Terracotta Army

Farmers in Xian, China, found fragments of a clay figure in the soil, leading to the discovery of more than 8,000 life-size clay soldiers known as the Terracotta Army. These models were buried close to the tomb of the first Chinese emperor Qin Shi Huang to protect him in the afterlife.

Born this day

1905 Philip Ahn, Korean-American actor. He enjoyed a long career and is remembered with his own star on the Walk of Fame in California, USA.

1927

Speedy Slug

The Sunbeam 1000 HP Mystery broke the land speed record, travelling at more than 320 kph (200 mph) on Daytona Beach, USA. Nicknamed "The Slug", this specially built car was powered by two aircraft engines.

